

China International Capital Corp. (3908.HK)

Earnings Review: M&A-driven capital deployment and international expansion support ROE recovery; Buy

3908.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$38.20	Price: HK\$22.54	Upside: 69.5%
601995.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb57.35	Price: Rmb34.73	Upside: 65.1%

CICC reported a solid 1H26 result, with earnings supported by stronger investment income, balance-sheet expansion and improving capital utilization. While fee-based businesses remained mixed, particularly in investment banking, operating leverage continued to improve, with annualized ROE reaching c.12.8% in 1H26. In our view, the results reinforce the ongoing shift in investor focus toward structural ROE drivers, including M&A-led capital deployment, international expansion and increased exposure to higher-return Hong Kong businesses, rather than solely by cyclical market activity.

The restructuring transaction (three-way merger) remains on track for formal closing around October following completion of key regulatory approvals. Management reiterated a medium-term ROE target of c.15%, supported by capital synergies, retail franchise expansion and international growth. We believe industry M&A/consolidation should accelerate capital concentration, improve capital utilization efficiency and widen differentiation among leading brokers.

Following the results and management guidance, we revise our forecasts to reflect stronger investment income, faster balance-sheet expansion and higher leverage assumptions, partly offset by softer investment banking revenue and brokerage commission growth; our estimates do not reflect the announced restructuring. We increase 2026E-28E revenue/net profit forecasts by 1%/9% on average, primarily driven by higher investment income assumptions, lower operating expense forecasts and more efficient balance-sheet deployment. We raise our 12-month target prices to HK\$ 38.20/Rmb 57.35 (from HK\$ 34.32/Rmb 51.53), based on unchanged 11x/18x 2027E P/E multiples for the H/A shares. Maintain Buy on **CICC-H**.

BUY

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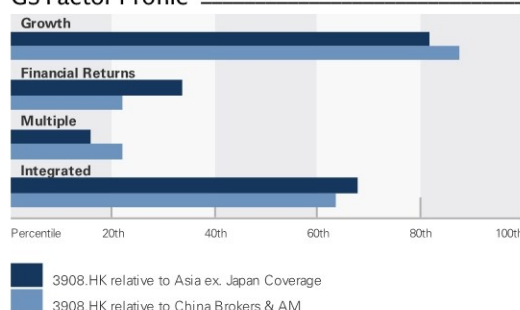
Key Data

Market cap: HK\$108.8bn / \$13.9bn
3m ADTV: HK\$324.9mn / \$41.4mn
China
China Brokers & AM
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (Rmb mn) New	28,481.1	38,880.3	37,985.4	38,470.1
Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	28,481.1	38,528.1	37,126.2	38,899.5
Net inc. (Rmb mn)	9,790.5	15,745.3	15,380.9	15,581.5
Net inc. growth (%)	71.9	60.8	(2.3)	1.3
EPS (Rmb) New	2.03	3.26	3.19	3.23
EPS (Rmb) Old	2.03	3.00	2.86	3.02
P/E (X)	7.9	5.9	6.1	6.0
P/B (X)	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.6
Dividend yield (%)	1.1	1.5	1.5	1.5
	3/26	6/26	9/26E	12/26E
EPS (Rmb)	0.74	0.96	0.66	0.90

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

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(3908.HK)**

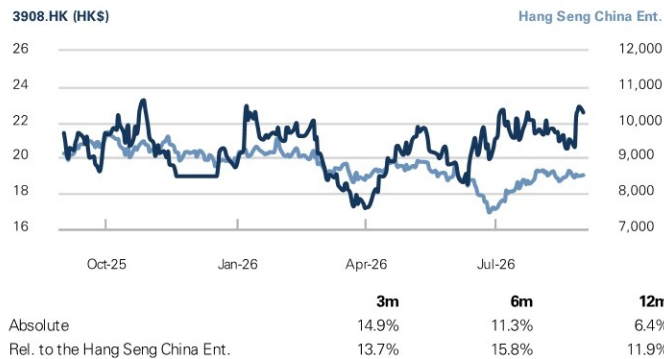
Rating since Nov 29, 2022

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	7.9	5.9	6.1	6.0
Price/PPOP (X)	7.8	4.7	4.8	4.8
P/B (X)	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.6
Dividend yield (%)	1.1	1.5	1.5	1.5
ROA (%)	1.3	1.7	1.5	1.4
ROE (%)	8.2	12.0	10.4	9.6
Turnover (X)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	2.3	2.1	1.8	1.7
Leverage (X)	6.3	6.9	6.6	6.3
Leverage (excl. bkge. Dep.) (X)	5.2	5.5	5.3	5.1

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net revenue growth	33.5	36.5	(2.3)	1.3
Commissions/op. rev.	16.2	16.8	13.8	13.9
Inv. banking fees as % of rev.	17.7	15.6	17.7	18.9
Asset mgmt. fees as % of rev.	11.0	9.0	10.0	10.5
Principal trans. as % of rev.	—	—	—	—
Net int. inc. as % of rev.	NM	0.4	NM	0.4
Operating exp. growth	15.1	14.9	(2.0)	1.1
Net inc. growth	71.9	60.8	(2.3)	1.3
Asset growth	16.0	31.5	4.6	4.5
Net margin	34.4	40.5	40.5	40.5
Commissions/op. rev.	16.2	16.8	13.8	13.9

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 31 Aug 2026 close.

Income Statement (Rmb mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Commissions	6,170.8	8,324.5	6,805.9	6,977.4
Investment banking fees	5,031.1	6,047.6	6,712.3	7,264.4
Asset management fees	3,132.7	3,502.4	3,794.5	4,023.2
Principal transactions	—	—	—	—
Net interest income	(1,037.9)	138.1	(41.7)	140.0
Other operating income	15,184.4	20,867.7	20,714.5	20,064.9
Net revenue	28,481.1	38,880.3	37,985.4	38,470.1
Compensation & benefits exp.	—	—	—	—
Total non-compensation exp.	(16,552.6)	(19,011.9)	(18,629.8)	(18,840.7)
Total non-int. exp. (incl. prov. loan)	(16,876.0)	(19,409.1)	(19,053.9)	(19,293.6)
Pre-provision op. profit	11,928.4	19,868.4	19,355.7	19,629.4
Provision for loans	(323.4)	(397.2)	(424.1)	(452.9)
Net operating profit	11,605.0	19,471.2	18,931.6	19,176.5
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Profit/(loss) on disposals	—	—	—	—
Total other net	107.7	51.3	53.8	56.5
Pre-tax profit	11,712.7	19,522.5	18,985.4	19,233.0
Provision for taxes	(1,912.4)	(3,708.4)	(3,606.4)	(3,653.4)
Minority interest	(9.9)	(68.7)	1.9	1.9
Net inc. pre-preferred div.	9,790.5	15,745.3	15,380.9	15,581.5
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	9,790.5	15,745.3	15,380.9	15,581.5
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	9,790.5	15,745.3	15,380.9	15,581.5
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (Rmb)	2.03	3.26	3.19	3.23
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (Rmb)	2.03	3.26	3.19	3.23
DPS (Rmb)	0.18	0.29	0.28	0.29
Div. payout ratio (%)	8.9	8.9	8.9	8.9

Balance Sheet (Rmb mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	149,701.9	204,436.8	216,273.5	229,053.6
Repos (assets)	—	—	—	—
Total securities	461,852.9	580,594.7	602,178.6	624,712.2
Customer receivables	44,056.0	80,181.9	84,191.0	88,400.6
Other receivables	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Total receivables	44,056.0	80,181.9	84,191.0	88,400.6
Net PP&E	5,596.6	5,543.1	5,819.5	6,109.7
Net intangibles	3,530.2	3,721.0	3,930.8	4,161.6
Other assets	—	—	—	—
Total assets	782,826.2	1,029,627.9	1,076,935.6	1,125,828.4
Brokerage deposits	130,104.7	200,040.6	209,668.4	219,777.5
Comm. paper & short-term debt	76,869.2	73,025.8	76,677.1	80,510.9
Repos (liabilities)	112,569.8	146,340.7	153,657.7	161,340.6
Other	—	—	—	—
Long-term debt	136,950.1	153,384.1	156,451.8	159,580.9
Other liabilities	191,162.7	294,796.0	303,807.4	313,098.9
Total liabilities	658,437.7	879,998.3	913,294.0	947,991.9
Total common equity	122,057.7	141,318.0	155,332.0	169,528.7
Preferred shares, eq. portion	—	—	—	—
Minority interest	2,330.8	8,311.6	8,309.7	8,307.8
Total shareholders' equity	124,388.5	149,629.6	163,641.7	177,836.5
Total liabilities & equity	782,826.2	1,029,627.9	1,076,935.6	1,125,828.4
Period end shares	4,827.3	4,827.3	4,827.3	4,827.3

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

We expect investors to focus on: 1) post-merger integration progress and synergy realization; 2) capital deployment following completion of the restructuring transaction; 3) sustainability of investment income and investment yields; 4) international business expansion and associated profitability improvement; and 5) the path toward management's medium-term ROE target of around 15%.

1. Capital deployment and investment income continued to support earnings growth

The key earnings driver in 1H26 remained investment-related businesses. Our revised forecasts increase 2026E-28E investment income estimates by 23%/25%/17%, reflecting stronger-than-expected investment performance, higher investment yields and a larger balance sheet. This is consistent with management's comments on stronger investment performance, **CXMT**-related gains and expanding capital deployment opportunities following the transaction.

More importantly, we believe the post-results call comments reinforce our broader sector thesis that improved capital utilization, rather than purely cyclical market recovery, is becoming an increasingly important driver of broker ROE improvement. Management highlighted three key post-merger capital allocation priorities: international business expansion, capital-intensive client activities and selective direct investments. Historically, management has characterized capital availability as one of the company's main development bottlenecks, suggesting potential for significant balance-sheet expansion following successful completion of the planned restructuring transaction.

We therefore raise active leverage assumptions to 5.9x/5.6x/5.4x in 2026E-28E versus 5.3x/5.1x/4.9x previously, in line with mgmt guidance. Our forecasts also align with our sector work indicating that Hong Kong capital deployment can incrementally improve leverage and ROE over time, particularly for brokers with strong offshore franchises like **CICC**.

2. Investment banking and wealth management remain long-term growth pillars despite mixed near-term trends

Despite a supportive Hong Kong and A-share financing environment, we reduce our 2026E-28E investment banking revenue forecasts by 33%/27%/27%, reflecting softer-than-expected execution in 2Q26. Brokerage commission forecasts are also lowered by approximately 3% over the forecast horizon.

Nevertheless, management remains constructive on the medium-term outlook, citing continued financing demand from AI, semiconductors and advanced manufacturing, alongside increasing concentration toward leading franchises. Management also expects the enlarged capital base to strengthen the firm's ability to participate across the full client lifecycle, while deepening coordination across investment banking, principal investment and private-equity businesses. We believe this supports our sector view that leading brokers are increasingly benefiting from both industry consolidation and participation across the broader technology investment value chain.

Wealth management remains a key strategic growth pillar. Management attributed recent momentum to advisory capabilities, product development and structural shifts in household asset allocation. A successful completion of the pending restructuring would

further expand the client base, while continued investment in research, technology and AI-enabled services would support client engagement and product penetration. We remain positive on the long-term growth outlook for broker wealth-management businesses.

3. M&A execution, international expansion and Hong Kong capital deployment remain the key medium-term ROE debates

We continue to view successful post-restructuring integration and international expansion as the potential medium-term ROE catalysts. With formal closing expected around October, management reiterated a medium-term ROE target of ~15%, supported by capital synergies, retail franchise expansion and stronger coordination across business lines. We continue to believe industry consolidation can improve capital concentration, increase market share and create additional ROE uplift opportunities through both cost synergies and more efficient capital allocation, thus accelerating industry differentiation. In **CICC's** case, we believe post-merger capital deployment into higher-return businesses, particularly offshore operations, provide scope for medium-term ROE delivery.

International business remains the primary destination for incremental capital. Management expects the first Rmb 4.2bn capital injection into **CICC International** by year-end or early next year and reiterated that this represents only the first step of a broader five-year expansion plan. Notably, management maintained guidance for international leverage above 10x and international ROE above 20%, which we view as consistent with our sector thesis that Hong Kong capital deployment can provide meaningful leverage and ROE uplift while increasing offshore earnings contribution.

Model implications and valuation

Reflecting stronger investment income, higher leverage and lower cost assumptions, we raise 2026E-28E attributable profit forecasts by 9% on average, with revenue forecasts increased by 1% on average and operating expense forecasts lowered by -4% on average. Our revised forecasts imply ROE of 12.0%/10.4%/9.6% in 2026E-28E, compared with 11.0%/9.3%/9.0% previously. We believe the earnings revisions further support our positive view that M&A-driven capital deployment, international expansion and improving capital utilization efficiency can support a gradual ROE recovery over the medium term. Consistent with our latest sector framework, we expect investor focus to increasingly shift from cyclical earnings delivery toward the sustainability of ROE improvement through integration execution, offshore expansion and capital deployment. We raise our 12-month target prices to HK\$ 38.20/Rmb 57.35 (from HK\$ 34.32/Rmb 51.53), based on unchanged 11x/18x 2027E P/E multiples for H/A shares. Maintain Buy on **CICC-H**.

Exhibit 1: CICC model revision

Rmb mn

CICC Rmb mn	New			Old			Change		
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Net fee and commission income	18,947	18,384	19,390	22,037	20,914	22,014	-14%	-12%	-12%
Brokerage commission	8,324	6,806	6,977	8,585	7,040	7,189	-3%	-3%	-3%
Investment banking income	6,048	6,712	7,264	9,033	9,226	9,944	-33%	-27%	-27%
Asset Management	3,502	3,794	4,023	3,372	3,603	3,783	4%	5%	6%
Net interest income (expense)	138	(42)	140	(30)	71	259	-561%	-158%	-46%
Investment income	20,585	20,434	19,730	16,730	16,349	16,835	23%	25%	17%
Net Total Revenues	38,880	37,985	38,470	38,528	37,126	38,900	1%	2%	-1%
Administrative expenses	(18,855)	(18,478)	(18,687)	(19,882)	(18,894)	(19,665)	-5%	-2%	-5%
Total Operating Expense	(19,012)	(18,630)	(18,841)	(20,035)	(19,041)	(19,819)	-5%	-2%	-5%
NPAT	15,745	15,381	15,582	14,468	13,819	14,564	9%	11%	7%
Key metrics									
Cost to income ratio	49%	49%	49%	52%	51%	51%	-310bps	-224bps	-198bps
ROE	12.0%	10.4%	9.6%	11.0%	9.3%	9.0%	100bps	105bps	56bps
Active leverage (x)	5.9x	5.6x	5.4x	5.3x	5.1x	4.9x	0.6x	0.6x	0.5x
Total leverage (x)	7.3x	6.9x	6.6x	6.5x	6.2x	6.0x	0.8x	0.7x	0.7x
ROA	1.7%	1.5%	1.4%	1.7%	1.5%	1.5%	4bps	-1bps	-7bps
Investment yield (annualized)	5.6%	4.8%	4.5%	4.9%	4.5%	4.5%	62bps	29bps	-1bps
Credit cost (annualized)	0.4%	0.4%	0.4%	0.8%	0.8%	0.8%	-37bps	-37bps	-37bps

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings call key takeaways

- **M&A (restructuring) with Cinda and Dongxing Securities remains on track**, with major regulatory approvals completed and formal closing expected in October; institutional business integration targeted within 3-6 months post-closing and retail integration within one year. Post-merger capital deployment will focus on international business, client-driven capital-intensive activities and selective direct investments, addressing historical capital constraints.
- **Management reaffirmed a medium-term ROE target of around 15%**, supported by capital deployment, retail franchise expansion and synergies with the two AMC shareholders.
- **International expansion remains the highest-priority capital allocation area**, with an initial Rmb 4.2bn capital injection into **CICC International** expected by year-end or early 2027 and further capital support planned over the next five years. Management reiterated confidence in sustaining international leverage above 10x and international ROE above 20%, supporting group-level ROE expansion.
- **Management remains positive on investment banking trends**, citing strong financing demand from AI, semiconductors and advanced manufacturing, alongside increasing concentration toward leading franchises.
- **Investment income outlook remains constructive**, supported by **CXMT** related investment income, expanding balance-sheet deployment and a broader capital base following the restructuring.
- **Derivative business growth continues to be driven primarily by offshore prime brokerage and non-linear derivatives(EDS)**, with management optimistic on future capital support and business expansion.
- **Wealth management remains a core strategic pillar**, supported by structural shifts in household asset allocation, growing client penetration, investment-advisory

capabilities and additional retail customer acquisition through the restructuring.

- **July-August business trends remained broadly stable**, excluding one-off investment gains from the **CXMT** co-investment, with management highlighting balanced business exposure and diversification benefits across asset-based and fixed-income businesses.
- **Management emphasized that industry consolidation is likely to continue**, viewing M&A as supportive for market share concentration, capital efficiency and long-term competitiveness.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - China International Capital Corp.

We are Buy/Neutral on **CICC-H/CICC-A**. Our 12-month target prices of HK\$ 38.20/Rmb 57.35 are based on 11x/18x 2027E P/Es.

Downside risks: 1) weaker-than-expected China capital market, 2) OTC derivative losses, 3) decreased AUM and fee rate, 4) higher cost-to-income ratio.

Upside risks for A shares: 1) improving brokerage fee and IBD income, 2) increasing OTC derivative business and income growth, 3) more cost savings to support ROE.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Shuo Yang, Ph.D. and Claire Ouyang, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

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Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed in the Contributing Authors disclosure of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

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The Goldman Sachs Factor Profile provides investment context for a stock by comparing key attributes to the market (i.e. our universe of rated stocks) and its sector peers. The four key attributes depicted are: Growth, Financial Returns, Multiple (e.g. valuation) and Integrated (a composite of Growth, Financial Returns and Multiple). Growth, Financial Returns and Multiple are calculated by using normalized ranks for specific metrics for each stock. The normalized ranks for the metrics are then averaged and converted into percentiles for the relevant attribute. The precise calculation of each metric may vary depending on the fiscal year, industry and region, but the standard approach is as follows:

Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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M&A Rank

Across our global coverage, we examine stocks using an M&A framework, considering both qualitative factors and quantitative factors (which may vary across sectors and regions) to incorporate the potential that certain companies could be acquired. We then assign a M&A rank as a means of scoring companies under our rated coverage from 1 to 3, with 1 representing high (30%-50%) probability of the company becoming an acquisition target, 2 representing medium (15%-30%) probability and 3 representing low (0%-15%) probability. For companies ranked 1 or 2, in line with our standard departmental guidelines we incorporate an M&A component into our target price. M&A rank of 3 is considered immaterial and therefore does not factor into our price target, and may or may not be discussed in research.

Quantum

Quantum is Goldman Sachs' proprietary database providing access to detailed financial statement histories, forecasts and ratios. It can be used for in-depth analysis of a single company, or to make comparisons between companies in different sectors and markets.

Disclosures

The rating(s) for China International Capital Corp. (A) and China International Capital Corp. (H) is/are relative to the other companies in its/their coverage universe: CITIC Securities Co. (H), CITIC Securities Co.(A), China International Capital Corp. (A), China International Capital Corp. (H), East Money Information Co., Futu Holdings, GF Securities Co. (A), GF Securities Co.(H), Hundsun, UP Fintech Holding

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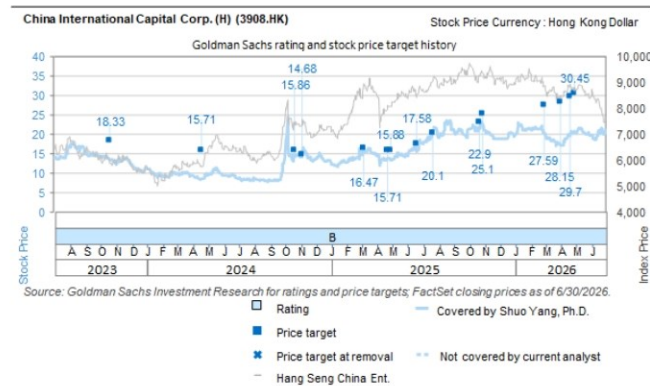
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

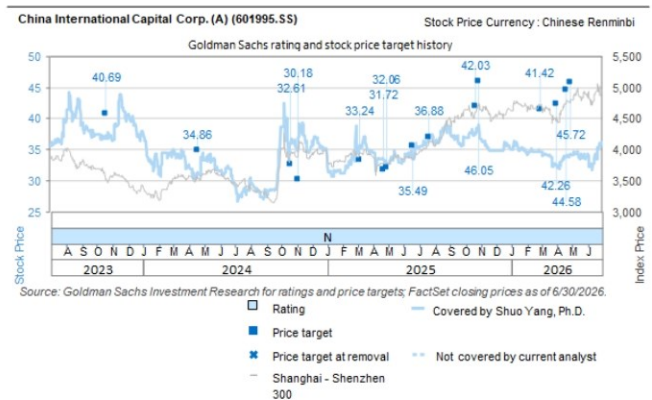
	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

As of July 1, 2026, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research had investment ratings on 3,104 equity securities. Goldman Sachs assigns stocks as Buys and Sells on various regional Investment Lists; stocks not so assigned are deemed Neutral. Such assignments equate to Buy, Hold and Sell for the purposes of the above disclosure required by the FINRA Rules. See 'Ratings, Coverage universe and related definitions' below. The Investment Banking Relationships chart reflects the percentage of subject companies within each rating category for whom Goldman Sachs has provided investment banking services within the previous twelve months.

Price target and rating history chart(s)



The price targets shown should be considered in the context of all prior published Goldman Sachs research, which may or may not have included price targets, as well as developments relating to the company, its industry and financial markets.



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Target price history table(s)

China International Capital Corp. (A) (601995.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
22-Jul-26	51.53	35.75
30-Apr-26	45.72	34.23
21-Apr-26	44.58	33.93
01-Apr-26	42.26	32.68
27-Feb-26	41.42	34.65
29-Oct-25	46.05	39.03
22-Oct-25	42.03	37.42
21-Jul-25	36.88	36.61
19-Jun-25	35.49	33.79
28-Apr-25	32.06	32.86
22-Apr-25	31.72	33.53
06-Mar-25	33.24	35.81
04-Nov-24	30.18	35.77
21-Oct-24	32.61	35.86
18-Apr-24	34.86	31.34
20-Oct-23	40.69	37.23

China International Capital Corp. (H) (3908.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
22-Jul-26	34.32	22.18
30-Apr-26	30.45	20.22
21-Apr-26	29.70	19.94
01-Apr-26	28.15	17.20
27-Feb-26	27.59	20.26
29-Oct-25	25.10	22.74
22-Oct-25	22.90	21.34
21-Jul-25	20.10	20.55
19-Jun-25	17.58	15.64
28-Apr-25	15.88	13.28
22-Apr-25	15.71	13.80
06-Mar-25	16.47	15.86
04-Nov-24	14.68	14.72
21-Oct-24	15.86	14.22
18-Apr-24	15.71	8.60
20-Oct-23	18.33	13.36

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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